

Case Study: Phishing

1. Description :Phishing is a type of cybercrime in which attackers pretend to be a trusted organization to trick individuals into sharing sensitive information such as passwords, bank details, or OTPs. It is one of the most common online fraud techniques used to gain unauthorized access to personal or financial data.

2. How It Happens : Phishing typically occurs in a series of steps. First, the attacker sends a fake mail, SMS, or message that appears to come from a legal source such as a bank or online service. The message then creates urgency by warning that the user account will be blocked. It then includes a link that redirects the victim to a fake website designed to look like the original one. When the victim then enters their login credentials or personal details, the attacker captures this information. Finally, the attacker uses the stolen data for unauthorized access or financial fraud.

3. Target Audience :Phishing attacks commonly target students, elderly individuals, and people who frequently use online banking or shopping platforms. These groups are often targeted because they may be less aware of cyber threats or more likely to trust such messages.

4. Consequences : The consequences of phishing can be serious. Victims suffer financial loss, identity theft, and unauthorized access to their accounts. Personal data may be misused, and recovering compromised accounts can be difficult. In some cases, victims also experience stress and loss of trust in online systems.

5. Conclusion : Phishing is a serious cyber threat that continues to grow. Staying aware, verifying links and messages, and avoiding sharing sensitive information are essential steps to protect oneself online.